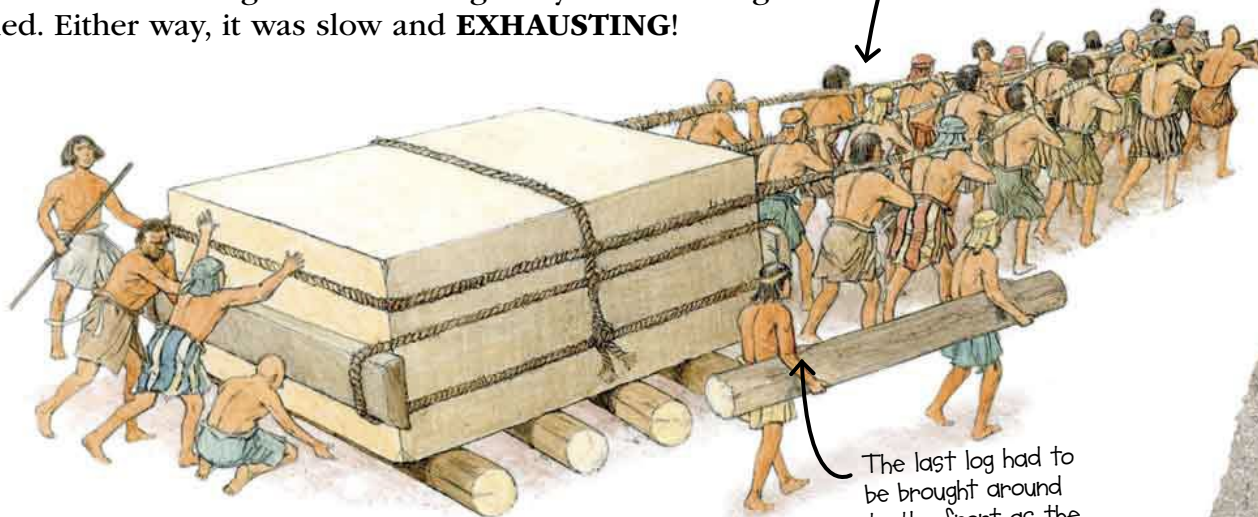


Rolling along

Before wheels, if you wanted to move something **enormous and heavy**, you would need some logs and **a lot of people**. You'd place the logs on the ground, slide your object on top of them, and then get your friends to use the logs to roll it along. Or you could drag a sled. Either way, it was slow and **EXHAUSTING!**

People or animals pulled the object across the log rollers on ropes, and others pushed from behind.



The last log had to be brought around to the front as the object moved forward.

The wheel

Imagine life without wheels: no cars or bikes for a start, and no cogs and gears inside machines, either. With so many wheels around, they might just be the most important invention of them all.

Making the world go ROUND AND ROUND

Wheely useful

Watching log rollers in action, someone, somewhere, had a **flash of inspiration**: Wheels attached to axles would be **SO MUCH BETTER!**

The first wheels we know about were made **5,000 years ago** in Mesopotamia (modern-day Iraq) and Slovenia. They were attached to simple carts pulled by animals, while everyone had a nice rest.

Stone wheels were used for grinding, but are too heavy to move vehicles.

It paved the way for...

GEARS AND COGS are used in machines to **MULTIPLY FORCE**, and were first used in ancient Greece.

Water wheels were invented in **ANCIENT GREECE**, and were used to irrigate crops and grind corn.

